

UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

SUNDAY, 27 SEPTEMBER 2026

11 must-know stories, 27 Prelims facts, 15 editorials and 12 explainers, picked from 597 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

[Open this brief online: summaries, Ask Intel and practice MCQs](#)

MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2

MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court Upholds Constitutionality of West Bengal Land (Requisition and Acquisition) Act, 1948 Under Article 19(1)(f) and (5). The State's Requisitioning Powers for Public Purposes Were Held to Impose Reasonable Restrictions and Provide Fair Comp

The Supreme Court delivered a verdict testing the validity of the West Bengal Land (Requisition and Acquisition) Act, 1948. The Supreme Court upheld the constitutional validity of the West Bengal Land (Requisition and Acquisition) Act, 1948, ruling it imposes reasonable restrictions and provides fair compensation.

When: 2026-09-27 · **Where:** West Bengal · **Who:** Supreme Court of India · **Prelims:** The statute in question is the West Bengal Land (Requisition and Acquisition) Act, 1948.; The judgment evaluates provisions under Article 19(1)(f) and Article 19(5).

Why it matters — Clarifies the constitutional validity of pre-constitutional state land acquisition statutes.; Reinforces the doctrine of eminent domain and the scope of reasonable restrictions under Article 19.

Static — Article 19(1)(f) of the Constitution originally guaranteed the right to acquire, hold and dispose of property, but was repealed by the 44th Amendment Act, 1978. Article 19(5) allows the State to impose reasonable restrictions on the exercise of property rights in the interests of the general public. Eminent domain is the inherent power of the state to seize private property for public use, subject to due process and compensation.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

[Lawtext: read the source](#)

GS2

MAKE NOTES

Only constitutional courts can impose modified life term sentences, not trial courts: Supreme Court

The Supreme Court ruled that only constitutional courts can impose a modified life sentence excluding the possibility of remission. The ruling came while partly allowing an appeal by Amjad Khan, who was convicted of murdering his wife and two young children. The core issue focuses on whether inferior courts possess the jurisdiction to curtail a convict's right to seek statutory remission. A bench of Justices B V Nagarathna and Augustine George Masih delivered the judgment regarding the Chhattisgarh trial court's order. The trial court had directed life imprisonment till the death of the accused, a qualification the apex court deemed outside trial court jurisdiction. The court noted that a trial court can award life imprisonment under Section 302 IPC but cannot attach conditions extinguishing remission rights. The power to prescribe fixed incarceration without remission or remainder of natural life imprisonment resides exclusively with High Courts and the Supreme Court. The apex court substituted the original direction with a sentence of life imprisonment meaning twenty years without remission.

When: 2026-09-27 · **Where:** Bilaspur district, Chhattisgarh · **Who:** Justices B V Nagarathna and Augustine George Masih · **Prelims:** The case involved appellant Amjad Khan convicted under Section 302 of the IPC.; The deaths occurred in Bilaspur district on the night of August 9, 2018.; The Supreme Court modified the sentence to life imprisonment meaning twenty years without remission.

Why it matters — Reinforces the constitutional and statutory framework governing prisoner remission rights in India.; Clarifies the jurisdictional limits of trial courts and Sessions Courts in sentencing matters.

Static — Constitutional courts in India comprise the Supreme Court of India and the various High Courts, possessing powers of judicial review. Remission of sentences allows the reduction of the period of imprisonment without changing the character of the sentence, governed via statutory provisions. Articles 72 and 161 of the Constitution empower the President and Governors respectively to grant pardons, reprieves, respites, or remissions of punishment.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

[deccanherald.com: read the source](#)

Governance & Policy

GS2

MAKE NOTES

Census vital national duty: PM Modi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi stated that the Census is a national responsibility vital for planning the country's future. The trigger was his monthly Mann Ki Baat radio address where he urged citizens to self-enumerate online. The core issue is ensuring accurate data collection through citizen participation using mobile phones and online portals. More than 2.6 crore people have completed self-enumeration on the Census portal using mobile phones so far. The online self-registration facility is available in 16 regional languages alongside Hindi across the country. Data of over 32 crore families has been recorded, with work ongoing in remote regions like Ladakh, Himachal Pradesh, Jammu and Kashmir, and Uttarakhand. Citizens can use the portal se.census.gov.in without uploading any documents, taking about 15 to 20 minutes. After submitting details, citizens receive a special ID to share with Census enumerators when they visit home. The prime minister also highlighted environmental conservation efforts, wildlife protection in Assam, and the Poshan Tracker for nutrition.

When: 2026-09-27 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Narendra Modi (Prime Minister) · **Prelims:** More than 2.6 crore people have completed self-enumeration on the Census portal.; The Census online portal is se.census.gov.in.; The self-enumeration facility is available in Hindi and 16 regional languages.

Why it matters — Encourages citizen participation and digital governance in national statistical exercises.; Highlights the shift towards digital self-enumeration using mobile phones and regional languages.

Static — The Census in India is conducted under the Census Act of 1948, providing the legal framework for decennial population counts. The Office of the Registrar General and Census Commissioner, under the Ministry of Home Affairs, is responsible for conducting the Census. The decennial Census is one of the largest administrative and statistical exercises in the world, collecting demographic and socio-economic data.

Syllabus: GS2: Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Report/Index

[theprint.in: read the source](#)

International Relations

GS2

MAKE NOTES

India Calls Out Terror at UNGA, Affirms Right to Self-Defence, Rules Out Dialogue Amid Cross-Border Acts

External Affairs Minister Dr S Jaishankar addressed the 81st session of the United Nations General Assembly in New York. He delivered a firm message against state-sponsored cross-border terrorism, declaring that friendship and goodwill cannot coexist with terror. India asserted its right to self-defence against terrorism, emphasizing a zero-tolerance approach and accountability for governments indulging in terror. The address raised serious concerns over attacks on commercial shipping from the Red Sea to the Black Sea, endangering seafarers and disrupting supplies. India partnered with Liberia and 23 other nations to rally global public opinion for maritime security and adherence to international law. On West Asia, Jaishankar stated that durable peace requires a two-state solution and highlighted India's ongoing humanitarian relief for Palestinians. The speech addressed the severe 'four F' crisis of food, fuel, fertilizer, and finance affecting the Global South. The address called for reformed multilateralism, transparent global decision-making, and framed artificial intelligence as a driver for human empowerment.

When: 2026-09-27 · **Where:** New York · **Who:** Dr S Jaishankar · **Prelims:** The session addressed was the 81st session of the United Nations General Assembly.; India partnered with Liberia and 23 other nations for maritime security.; Dr S Jaishankar addressed the UNGA in New York.

Why it matters — Reiterates India's firm diplomatic stance against cross-border terrorism on a major global stage.; Highlights India's leadership role in voicing concerns of the Global South regarding food, fuel, fertilizer, and finance crises.

Static — The United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) is the main deliberative, policymaking, and representative organ of the UN, established in 1945 under the UN Charter. All 193 UN member states are members of the General Assembly, providing a unique forum for multilateral discussion of the full spectrum of international issues. India is one of the founding members of the United Nations and has consistently been a major contributor to UN peacekeeping operations globally.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations, Internal Security, Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

[indiatoday.in: read the source](#) · also reported by [India Today](#), [Hindustan Times](#), [Firstpost](#), [organiser.org](#)

GS2

MAKE NOTES

G4 Countries Renew Push For UN Security Council Reform, Reject 'Bridging' Proposal

The G4 nations renewed their collective push during high-level diplomatic meetings at the United Nations. The G4 countries held a ministerial meeting to renew their demand for comprehensive reforms of the United Nations Security Council while rejecting intermediate bridging proposals.

When: 2026-09-27 · **Where:** New York · **Who:** G4 Countries (India, Brazil, Germany, Japan) · **Prelims:** G4 countries consist of India, Brazil, Germany, and Japan.; The G4 nations rejected the bridging proposal regarding UN Security Council reform.

Why it matters — Highlights India's ongoing diplomatic efforts to secure a permanent seat at the UN Security Council.; Reflects the developing nations' push for a more inclusive and representative global multilateral governance structure.

Static — The G4 nations comprise India, Brazil, Germany, and Japan, which support each other's bids for permanent seats on the United Nations Security Council. The United Nations Security Council consists of five permanent members with veto power and ten non-permanent members elected for two-year terms. UNSC reform requires an amendment of the UN Charter, which needs a two-thirds majority vote in the General Assembly and ratification by all five permanent members.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations

[BW Businessworld: read the source](#)

Social Justice & Welfare

GS2

MAKE NOTES

Change in transgender law cannot take away rights already given, Supreme Court tells Centre

Petitioners representing the transgender community urged the court to prevent authorities from cancelling their existing transgender ID cards. The Supreme Court informed the Centre that any changes in transgender laws cannot retroactively take away rights and identity cards already granted to community members. The petitioners, representing members of the community, urged the court to prevent authorities from cancelling transgender ID cards.

When: 2026-09-27 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court, Centre, Petitioners representing the transgender community · **Prelims:** Petitioners represented members of the transgender community.; The Supreme Court addressed the Centre regarding transgender ID cards.; Petitioners urged the court to prevent authorities from cancelling transgender ID cards.

Why it matters — *Reaffirms the inviolability of legally acquired rights against subsequent legislative or administrative changes.; Provides crucial judicial safeguards for transgender persons against arbitrary cancellation of identity documents.*

Static — The Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Act, 2019, governs the legal recognition and protection of transgender persons in India. Under the 2019 Act, a transgender person has the right to be recognized as such, and can obtain a certificate of identity from the District Magistrate. The Supreme Court in the landmark 2014 National Legal Services Authority (NALSA) v. Union of India judgment recognized transgender persons as the 'third gender' and affirmed their fundamental rights.

Syllabus: GS2: Social Justice & Welfare, Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

[The Hindu: read the source](#)

GS2 GS3

MAKE NOTES

How EPFO wage ceiling reset will change PF contribution math

The Employees' Provident Fund Organisation has raised the mandatory wage ceiling from Rs 15,000 a month to Rs 25,000. The government raised the wage ceiling on September 17 to bring an estimated one crore more workers into the social security system. The change follows minimum wage increases beyond Rs 15,000 in seven states and union territories including Delhi, Maharashtra, and Karnataka. Under the new ceiling, an employee earning Rs 25,000 a month will contribute Rs 3,000 to PF, up from the earlier Rs 1,800. The employer's PF contribution for a Rs 25,000 wage will rise to Rs 917, while the pension scheme share will increase to Rs 2,083. For employees earning above the Rs 25,000 ceiling, such as Rs 35,000, there will be no mandatory EPS pension contribution. Employers are barred from recovering their statutory contributions from employees by factoring them into the cost-to-company structure. SMEs facing higher compliance costs may offset burdens using government incentives like the PM Viksit Bharat Rojgar Yojana.

When: September 17 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Employees' Provident Fund Organisation · **Prelims:** The new EPFO wage ceiling is Rs 25,000 a month.; The revised framework took effect on September 17.; Seven states and UTs raised minimum wages beyond Rs 15,000 prior to the change.

Why it matters — *Brings an estimated one crore additional workers under the formal social security and pension net.; Alters monthly take-home salaries and employer liabilities across various wage brackets.*

Static — The Employees' Provident Fund Organisation is a statutory body under the Ministry of Labour and Employment, Government of India. It administers the Employees' Provident Funds and Miscellaneous Provisions Act, 1952, which provides social security to organized sector workers. The central board of trustees administers the EPF scheme, Employees' Pension Scheme, and Employees' Deposit Linked Insurance scheme.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Social Justice & Welfare, Economy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

[Economic Times: read the source](#) · [free copy on msn.com](#) · also reported by [Legal Service India](#)

GS2

MAKE NOTES

'Marriage does not advance a child's age': Delhi HC rejects Muslim personal law defence in POCSO case

The Delhi High Court refused to quash a POCSO case against a man who married a 16-year-old girl. The petitioners argued that the marriage was valid under Muslim personal law as the girl had attained puberty. The core issue was whether personal law provisions regarding marriage and puberty can override statutory age limits under criminal law. Justice Sanjeev Narula held that marriage cannot advance a child's age or provide immunity from prosecution. The girl was 16 years and three months old at the time of marriage, while the man was nearly 28. The case came to light when the girl visited a government hospital during her pregnancy, leading to a mandatory report. The court stated that consent, lack of force, or constitutional freedoms cannot create exceptions to penal laws enacted to protect children. The High Court dismissed the petition, ruling that personal law cannot supply an exception where Parliament provided none.

When: 2026-09-27 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Justice Sanjeev Narula, Bilal · **Prelims:** The girl was born on September 19, 2008 and married on December 20, 2024.; The petitioner Bilal was born on January 1, 1997.; The case was registered under FIR No. 189/2026 at Darya Ganj Police Station.

Why it matters — *Reaffirms the supremacy of child protection statutes over personal law exemptions regarding the age of consent.; Clarifies that marital status cannot be used as a defence to bypass criminal liability under the POCSO Act.*

Static — The Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act, 2012, protects children from offences of sexual assault, sexual harassment and pornography, defining a child as any person below 18 years of age. The Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) replaced the Indian Penal Code and penalizes sexual intercourse with a minor, setting the age of consent at 18 years regardless of marital status. Article 21 of the Constitution guarantees right to life and personal liberty, while Articles 25 and 26 guarantee freedom of religion, subject to public order, morality and health.

Syllabus: GS2: Social Justice & Welfare, Polity & Constitution, Defence · Prelims angle: Judgment

[Times of India: read the source](#)

Economy

GS3

MAKE NOTES

Cabinet Approves ECLGS 5.0 to Support Businesses Amid West Asia Crisis

The Union Cabinet approved the fifth version of the Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS 5.0) to provide financial support to businesses. The scheme was triggered by liquidity pressures faced by businesses due to the ongoing West Asia situation and global disruptions. The core objective is to facilitate additional credit flow and help businesses manage short-term liquidity challenges and safeguard employment. It aims to facilitate a total additional credit flow of Rs. 2.55 lakh crore, with Rs. 5,000 crore earmarked specifically for the airline sector. MSMEs receive 100 per cent guarantee coverage on additional credit, while non-MSMEs and airlines are covered up to 90 per cent. Eligible borrowers include MSMEs, non-MSMEs, and scheduled passenger airlines with standard accounts as of March 31, 2026. Additional credit is capped at Rs. 100 crore per borrower for general entities and Rs. 1,500 crore per borrower for airlines. Loan tenures are five years for MSMEs and non-MSMEs with a one-year moratorium, and seven years for airlines with a two-year moratorium. The scheme applies to loans sanctioned from the issuance of NCGTC guidelines until March 31, 2027.

When: March 31, 2027 · **Where:** West Asia · **Who:** Union Cabinet, Prime Minister Narendra Modi, National Credit Guarantee Trustee Company Limited · **Prelims:** Total additional credit flow facilitated: Rs. 2.55 lakh crore; Amount earmarked for the airline sector: Rs. 5,000 crore; Guarantee coverage for MSMEs: 100 per cent

Why it matters — *Helps MSMEs and the aviation sector navigate short-term liquidity stress caused by international geopolitical disruptions.; Safeguards employment and ensures business continuity and stability in supply chains.*

Static — Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS) was originally launched by the Government of India as part of the Aatmanirbhar Bharat package to mitigate the economic distress caused by the COVID-19 pandemic. The scheme provides 100% credit guarantee to lending institutions (banks and financial institutions) to encourage them to extend collateral-free emergency credit to businesses. National Credit Guarantee Trustee Company Limited (NCGTC) is a wholly-owned company of the Department of Financial Services, Ministry of Finance, which acts as the trustee for operating various credit guarantee funds.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy

[ddnews.gov.in: read the source](#)

GS3

MAKE NOTES

Made-in-India phones get a PLI push as electronics firms receive Rs 19,091 crore

Large-scale electronics manufacturing companies have received Rs 19,090.98 crore in incentives up to June this year under the PLI scheme. The electronics sector attracted investments worth Rs 20,580.20 crore, representing the highest payout among all sectors covered by the scheme. Across 14 PLI schemes launched in 2020, the government disbursed a total of Rs 36,754 crore to beneficiary companies until June 30 this year. The large-scale electronics manufacturing scheme was introduced in 2020 with 32 approved beneficiary companies to boost domestic mobile phone manufacturing. The electronics manufacturing scheme tenure was initially meant to run for five years from 2020 to 2025 and was extended by one year to 2025-26. Smartphone exports from India increased to about \$30 billion in 2025-26 from \$5.5 billion in 2021-22, making smartphones a top exported commodity. India has emerged as the world's second-largest mobile manufacturer supported by the overarching PLI programme designed to strengthen manufacturing capabilities. Other sectors also received disbursements, including pharmaceuticals at Rs 6,662 crore, food products at Rs 3,271.440 crore, and automobile components at Rs 3,174.15 crore.

When: June 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) · **Prelims:** Electronics firms received Rs 19,090.98 crore in incentives up to June.; Total government disbursement across 14 PLI schemes till June 30 reached Rs 36,754 crore.; Smartphone exports increased to about \$30 billion in 2025-26 from \$5.5 billion in 2021-22.

Why it matters — *Reflects India's rapid rise to become the world's second-largest mobile manufacturer.; Demonstrates the tangible financial progress and export surge of the electronics manufacturing sector under the PLI framework.*

Static — The Production Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme was introduced by the central government to boost domestic manufacturing and cut down import dependence across key sectors. The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) functions under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry as the nodal agency tracking implementation and data. PLI schemes typically provide financial incentives ranging from 4% to 6% on incremental sales of manufactured goods over a designated base year.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

timesofindia.indiatimes.com: read the source · also reported by Rediff MoneyWiz

Infrastructure & Energy

GS3

MAKE NOTES

Amit Shah flags off India's 1st LNG train; targets zero diesel use in Railways by 2030

Union Home Minister Amit Shah and Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel flagged off India's first LNG-powered train from Sabarmati. The initiative aims to reduce dependence on conventional diesel fuel and promote alternative energy sources in railway operations. The core issue is cutting carbon emissions and fuel costs in the railway sector while targeting zero diesel use by 2030. The train uses a diesel-plus-LNG dual-fuel system developed for its Driving Power Cars, allowing LNG to replace up to 40 percent of diesel. Two 1,400 HP Driving Power Cars at the Sabarmati Integrated Coaching Depot were converted to this dual-fuel system. The converted power cars successfully completed more than 2,000 kilometres of field trials to test reliability and performance. Each converted Driving Power Car carries a 2,200-litre LNG tank holding about 850 to 900 kilograms of usable LNG. A full LNG fill supports around 1,600 kilometres of operation and the system can switch between LNG and diesel depending on availability. The wider railway package included projects worth over Rs 1,542 crore covering safety, signaling, and line capacity.

When: 2026-09-27 · **Where:** Sabarmati, Ahmedabad, Gujarat · **Who:** Amit Shah, Bhupendra Patel · **Prelims:** India's first LNG train was flagged off from Sabarmati.; The dual-fuel system allows LNG to replace up to 40 percent of diesel consumption.; Each converted Driving Power Car has a 2,200-litre LNG tank holding about 850-900 kg of usable LNG.

Why it matters — Helps reduce railway fuel expenditure and lowers emissions of carbon dioxide, nitrogen oxides, and particulate matter.; Aids the national goal of achieving zero diesel use in railway traction by 2030.

Static — Indian Railways operates one of the largest rail networks in the world, managed by the Ministry of Railways, Government of India. Mission 100% Electrification of Broad Gauge Routes aims to make Indian Railways a net-zero carbon emitter before 2030. Liquefied Natural Gas is being explored globally and in India as a cleaner transition fuel that produces lower sulfur and particulate emissions than diesel.

Syllabus: GS3: Infrastructure & Energy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

BusinessLine: read the source · free copy on gulfnews.com · also reported by Indian Express

PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

AGRICULTURE & ALLIED

QUICK READ

Union Minister Shri Rajiv Ranjan Singh alias Lalan Singh to Launch Livestock Insurance Portal in New Delhi on 28 September 2026

The Centre's Department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying will launch a dedicated Livestock Insurance Portal in New Delhi on 28 September 2026. The portal will be launched by Union Minister for Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying Shri Rajiv Ranjan Singh alias Lalan Singh. The platform aims to provide a single, integrated digital interface for streamlined policy issuance, claim processing, monitoring, and reporting.

PIB: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION

ACT/BILL/RULES

REPORT/INDEX

QUICK READ

Tamil Nadu government exempts Public (Law and Order) Department from RTI Act

The Tamil Nadu government exempted the Public (Law and Order) Department from the ambit of the Right to Information Act. The move classifies the department as an Intelligence and Security Organisation under Section 24(4) of the RTI Act. A Gazette notification was issued by the Human Resources Management Department following powers exercised by the Governor.

The Hindu: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY

SPECIES

QUICK READ

Keralam researchers discover a new species of genus Begonia in Western Ghats

The discovery of the new plant species was reported by researchers in Kerala. Researchers in Kerala discovered a new plant species belonging to the genus Begonia in the Western Ghats. Species christened Begonia rajvikramanii after R. Raj Vikraman, former Head of the Garden Management Division, JNTBGRI

The Hindu: source

AGRICULTURE & ALLIED

REPORT/INDEX

QUICK READ

Maharashtra drought: Crop inspection report work begins; CM Fadnavis raises worsening El Niño possibility

The Maharashtra government has started preparing crop inspection reports after declaring drought in 265 out of 358 talukas. Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis announced that appropriate financial assistance will be provided to affected farmers once reports are complete. The drought declaration covers 74 per cent of the state due to a significant rainfall deficit.

The Hindu: source

DEFENCE

EXERCISE

QUICK READ

Exercise Tarang Shakti 2026 begins operational phase at Jodhpur with seven foreign Air Forces

The Indian Air Force commenced the operational phase of Exercise Tarang Shakti 2026 at Air Force Station Jodhpur. The multilateral air exercise is being conducted from September 26 to October 12 with the theme Power in Partnership. Seven friendly foreign countries are participating to enhance interoperability, shared expertise, and mutual trust. Participating foreign nations include Australia, the United States, the United Arab Emirates, France, Germany, Sri Lanka, and Bangladesh.

[ddnews.gov.in: source](#)

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

ACT/BILL/RULES

AGREEMENT/MOU

QUICK READ

US trade deal could shield India from 100% tariff under Russian sanctions law: Sources

US President Donald Trump signed the Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026, allowing tariffs of up to 100 percent on countries buying Russian oil and gas. The law aims to curb Russian energy revenues and pressure buyers like India and China, raising concerns in New Delhi about bilateral ties and global energy stability.

[BusinessLine: source](#)

ECONOMY

JUDGMENT

QUICK READ

SC to hear on Monday plea challenging imposition of MDR on UPI payments above Rs. 2,000

The Supreme Court is set to hear a public interest litigation challenging the imposition of a Merchant Discount Rate on specified UPI transactions exceeding Rs. 2,000. The government introduced a 0.4 percent MDR on merchant transfers above Rs. 2,000 starting October 15, ending nearly six years of completely free UPI payments.

[Hindustan Times: source](#)

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY

QUICK READ

Cabinet approves railway multitracking projects worth Rs 18,509 crore across four states

The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs approved three major multitracking railway projects worth approximately Rs 18,509 crore. The projects include the Kasara-Manmad, Delhi-Ambala, and Ballari-Hosapete third and fourth railway lines. These projects will add about 389 km to the existing Indian Railways network across 12 districts in four states. The targeted completion period for these infrastructure expansion works is set for 2030-31.

[ddnews.gov.in: source](#)

DEFENCE

QUICK READ

INDIAN NAVAL SHIPS SAHYADRI AND KULISH CONCLUDE PARTICIPATION IN ADMM-PLUS MARITIME SECURITY JOINT COOPERATION ACTIVITY

Indian Navy's INS Sahyadri and INS Kulish concluded their participation in the 23rd ADMM-Plus Experts Working Group on Maritime Security Joint Cooperation Activity. The closing ceremony was held at Subic Bay, Philippines, marking the end of exercises that began on September 21, 2026. The Philippine Navy hosted the event, which was co-chaired by Japan, bringing together multiple regional maritime forces.

[PIB: source](#)

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY

QUICK READ

India's First Port-based e-Methanol Plant

Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel, Union Minister Sarbananda Sonowal, and Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma laid the foundation stone for India's first port-based e-methanol plant. The plant is located at the Deendayal Port Authority in Kandla, Gandhidham, Gujarat, and is built at a total cost of Rs 2,300 crore.

[Business Standard: source](#)

POLITY & CONSTITUTION

QUICK READ

Election Commission's Nine New Decisions

All three Election Commissioners held their first meeting on September 26 following media investigations alleging internal friction within the poll body. The meeting led to the release of a press note addressing controversies surrounding the SIR exercise, ECINet, and voter enrolment. Congress and opposition parties dismissed the press note as a damage control exercise, whereas the BJP argued it proved the allegations were manufactured.

[Insights on India: source](#)

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

QUICK READ

Jaishankar-Lavrov meet: Annual summit; BRICS Parliamentary Forum on agenda

The bilateral meeting between the Indian and Russian foreign ministers brought India-Russia summit preparations and multilateral cooperation into focus. External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar met Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov to discuss bilateral cooperation, the annual summit, and the BRICS Parliamentary Forum.

[The Economic Times: source](#)

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY

PLACE IN NEWS

QUICK READ

Kanniyakumari district administration moves for Ramsar status for salt pans in Puthalam, Andivilai and Swamithoppu

The district administration moved officially to seek the international Ramsar recognition for these local salt pans. The Kanniyakumari district administration has initiated a proposal to obtain Ramsar wetland status for salt pans in Puthalam, Andivilai, and Swamithoppu. [thehindu.com: source](#)

POLITY & CONSTITUTION

ACT/BILL/RULES

QUICK READ

Conversations To Commercials: Analyzing Meta's Policy Update Under Digital Personal Data Protection Act.

Meta introduced a policy update concerning business messaging and data use. Meta's recent policy update shifting conversations to commercials is being analyzed for its compliance with the Digital Personal Data Protection Act.

[Live Law: source](#)

GOVERNANCE & POLICY

SCHEME

QUICK READ

India Launches Digital Tourism Stack and Alternative Destinations Mission

Union Minister of Tourism Gajendra Singh Shekhawat launched the National Digital Tourism Stack and Dekho Apna Desh 2.0 campaign on World Tourism Day. The initiatives aim to distribute tourism demand widely, promote lesser-known destinations, and ensure balanced, inclusive, and sustainable growth. Dekho Apna Desh 2.0 focuses on hill, coastal, heritage, and pilgrimage destinations that have adequate infrastructure to receive additional visitors sustainably.

[msn.com: source](#)

AGRICULTURE & ALLIED

QUICK READ

Two-Day National Conference on Rabi Campaign 2026 to Begin Tomorrow in New Delhi

The event is scheduled to be held on 28-29 September 2026 to discuss preparedness, priorities, and Centre-State coordination for the Rabi season. The Department of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare is organising a two-day National Conference on Agriculture for Rabi Campaign 2026 in New Delhi to strategise for the upcoming Rabi season.

[PIB: source](#)

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

QUICK READ

Union Minister for Finance & Corporate Affairs Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman will embark on an official visit to Qatar from 27 to 29 September 2026

Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman is embarking on an official visit to Qatar from September 27 to 29, 2026. The visit is undertaken to lead a delegation of senior officials from the Ministry of Finance. The core purpose is to attend the 11th Annual Meeting of the Board of Governors of the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank in Doha on September 28.

[PIB: source](#)

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

AGREEMENT/MOU

QUICK READ

22A approved with win for NPP as IMF agreements remain pending

The legislative approval of 22A and the status of pending IMF agreements put this political and economic event in the news. The 22nd Amendment (22A) has been approved as a political victory for the NPP, while negotiations on IMF agreements are still pending.

[The Morning: source](#)

HEALTH

REPORT/INDEX

QUICK READ

Child rights panel seeks report on measles deaths in Keralam's Malappuram

The Keralam child rights panel sought a report from health officers regarding the deaths of two children from measles in Malappuram district. The commission noted with concern media reports indicating that both deceased children were unvaccinated against measles. The victims included a 10-month-old infant from Valavannur and a one-and-a-half-year-old toddler from Ponnala who died within a week.

[The Hindu: source](#)

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY

QUICK READ

Vice President Launches SURM Framework, AI-Driven Reservoir Management at India International Water Week

Vice-President C. P. Radhakrishnan inaugurated the 9th India International Water Week 2026 at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi. He launched the Sustainable Urban River Management (SURM) Framework and AI/ML-driven Integrated Reservoir Sediment Management during the event. The five-day event is organised by the Ministry of Jal Shakti from September 22 to 26 under the theme Climate Resilient Water Management.

[ddnews.gov.in: source](#)

INTERNAL SECURITY

REPORT/INDEX

QUICK READ

2025 Ladakh violence: Wangchuk seeks release of inquiry report, higher compensation for victims

Activist Sonam Wangchuk demanded the release of the judicial inquiry report into the 2025 Ladakh violence, higher compensation for victims, and accountability for state actions. The demands follow a year after violence left four people dead and led to his preventive detention under the National Security Act.

[Hindustan Times: source](#)

ECONOMY

REPORT/INDEX

QUICK READ

NITI Aayog releases report highlighting surge in women's participation in India's credit market

NITI Aayog released the second edition of its report titled From Borrowers to Builders: Women and India's Evolving Credit Market. The report was published in collaboration with the Women Entrepreneurship Platform, TransUnion CIBIL, and MicroSave Consulting. Women borrowers now account for a credit portfolio of Rs. 76 lakh crore, which constitutes 26% of India's total system credit.

[ddnews.gov.in: source](#)

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

QUICK READ

VP Shettima, Other World Leaders In India For 18th BRICS Summit

The arrival of global leaders for the 18th BRICS Summit in India put the event in the news. World leaders, including Nigerian Vice President Kashim Shettima, have arrived in India for the 18th BRICS Summit.

[LEADERSHIP Newspapers: source](#)

DEFENCE

QUICK READ

Pak's new Chinese Hangor submarine test-fires missile, India's sub plans still hang fire

Pakistan announced that its newly inducted Chinese-built AIP submarine, PNS/M Hangor, successfully test-fired an anti-ship cruise missile in the North Arabian Sea. The Pakistani military wing ISPR stated that the submarine accurately engaged a long-range target during a test witnessed by Pakistan Navy chief Admiral Naveed Ashraf.

[newindianexpress.com: source](#)

POLITY & CONSTITUTION

JUDGMENT

APPOINTMENT

QUICK READ

Supreme Court Orders Demolition Of 16,726 Illegal Structures In Meerut; Appoints Justice Dhulia...

The Supreme Court ordered the Uttar Pradesh government to seal 16,726 illegal properties and demolish unauthorised constructions in Meerut. The order came during a contempt petition hearing over non-compliance regarding illegal colonies that came up in Uldepur. A Bench comprising Justices J B Pardiwala and K V Viswanathan expressed shock and disturbance at the massive scale of unauthorised developments.

[newindianexpress.com: source](#)

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

QUICK READ

EAM S. Jaishankar chairs second FIPIC Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New York

External Affairs Minister Dr. S Jaishankar chaired the second FIPIC Foreign Ministers' Meeting on the sidelines of the 81st United Nations General Assembly in New York. The meeting reaffirmed the commitment to strengthen the FIPIC partnership and enhance cooperation in regional and multilateral fora. Participating leaders reviewed the outcomes of past FIPIC Summits and welcomed progress under the 12-Point Action Plan announced by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in 2023.

[newsonair.gov.in: source](#)

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

AGREEMENT/MOU

QUICK READ

Australia - India Partnership on Cyber, Critical Technologies and Supply Chains (PACTS)

The partnership remains a key point of reference in bilateral diplomatic updates issued by the Ministry of External Affairs. The Australia-India Partnership on Cyber, Critical Technologies and Supply Chains (PACTS) is a bilateral framework focusing on digital security and technology resilience.

[Ministry of External Affairs: source](#)

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS1 How the 1881 census fixed India's social map and identity lines forever

Published as an opinion piece examining the historical and ongoing impact of colonial census-taking on Indian social identity. An analysis of how the 1881 colonial census permanently shaped India's social map by embedding administrative biases into identity categories. Beyond counting people, the colonial census made Indian society measurable, while embedding the biases and power of its categories.

[ThePrint](#)

GS2 The RTI's shift to a 'right to deny information'

The ongoing debate and concern over how the DPDPA's amendment of Section 8(1)(j) affects public transparency. An editorial critique arguing that the Digital Personal Data Protection Act has undermined the RTI Act by converting it into a mechanism to deny information. Citizens and the media need to challenge the Digital Personal Data Protection Act's amendment of Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information (RTI) Act

[The Hindu](#)

GS2 There wasn't much to Xi: A red carpet, a fragile truce and the search for US-China stability

Chinese President Xi Jinping's state visit to Washington featured a grand opening ceremony and pageantry, but yielded modest final announcements. Announcements included tariff cuts on \$30 billion of non-sensitive goods, a new AI safety dialogue, and a two-month extension of the trade truce. The ongoing US war on Iran casts a heavy shadow over US-China relations, despite receiving little public mention during the summit.

[Economic Times](#)

GS3 Can dominant firms still offer discounts? Supreme Court's Schott ruling explained

The public perception of Indian competition law remains tied to the old MRTP Act, which viewed corporate domination as suspect in itself. The modern Competition Act, 2002, takes a nuanced approach and focuses on preventing the abuse of dominance rather than dominance itself. In the Schott case, Schott Glass supplied glass tubes to converters and entered the downstream market via a 50 percent joint venture. Schott offered bulk discounts and additional discounts under an agreement, prompting rival converters to allege discriminatory treatment and market crowding.

[Deccan Herald](#)

GS3 IRDAI faces pushback over proposed caps on insurance distribution costs, impacting fintech and insurer stocks

The proposal has triggered pushback from industry stakeholders and impacted fintech and insurer stocks. IRDAI's proposed caps on distribution commissions may face industry resistance after removal of earlier caps. The aim of the proposal is to push more funds into coverage rather than commissions to address issues of mis-selling. Disentangling the incentive structures into discrete components is a genuine requirement. Insurers with lower costs are expected to benefit. This will shape industry feedback to IRDAI's consultation paper.

[Economic Times](#)

GS2 Xi-Trump summit: China gains diplomatic leverage as US-China trade truce extends, Taiwan tensions persist

The Trump-Xi summit resulted in modest progress on trade issues, including reducing tariffs on \$30 billion worth of goods and extending a trade truce by two months. The two leaders agreed to establish a channel on AI safety, address rare earth supply chain issues, set up a Board of Investment, and have China buy 10 million tonnes of coal.

[Economic Times](#)

GS2 CEC, be proud of the high regard the Indian public has of the Election Commission: KR Narayanan

President KR Narayanan delivered a speech celebrating the Golden Jubilee of the Election Commission of India in January 2001. He noted that the founding fathers made a daring revolutionary act by introducing universal adult suffrage in a country of mass illiteracy and poverty. Mahatma Gandhi and Pandit Nehru viewed adult franchise as a means to unify diverse sections and politically educate the Indian masses. Public opinion polls rated the Election Commission very high, far ahead of the police, bureaucracy, political parties, and even the judiciary.

[ThePrint](#)

GS2 Trump-Xi Summit shows limits of US power. Grammar of great-power competition is changing

The Trump-Xi Summit in Washington exposed a central challenge for American strategy: the United States can impose costs on China, but its vast national power cannot compel Beijing to accept Washington's terms. Ahead of the summit, Washington and Beijing extended their trade truce by two months to January 10, 2027, as negotiations continued over tariffs, Chinese purchases, and rare-earth supplies. The summit helped keep competition manageable for now, but did little to resolve differences over Taiwan, Iran, or artificial intelligence.

[ThePrint](#)

GS3 Let's take stock of India's Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code: is it aligned with the economy's interests?

An evaluation of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code on its tenth anniversary, focusing on structural aspects and Section 29A. With the IBC completing 10 years of existence this year, it's a good time for policymakers to evaluate how well it serves the economy today. Three structural aspects deserve scrutiny, and Section 29A requires a reset to guard against its dampening effect on the deployment of risk capital.

[Mint](#)

GS2 Donald Trump-Xi Jinping meet: Little was achieved, but one big thing was avoided

The high-profile meeting between Donald Trump and Xi Jinping brought global attention to the state of US-China relations. An editorial analyzing the Donald Trump-Xi Jinping meeting, noting that while substantial achievements were absent, a major escalation was successfully avoided.

[Deccan Herald](#)

GS2 Fifth Column by Tavleen Singh: Democracy at work or disaster

Published as a regular opinion column in national newspapers. An opinion piece examining the challenges and nature of democracy and governance.

[Financial Express](#)

GS2 High-stakes Trump-Xi talks steer clear of conflict, short on substance

The editorial was prompted by the recent high-stakes meeting between Donald Trump and Xi Jinping. An editorial analyzing the high-stakes talks between Donald Trump and Xi Jinping, noting they avoided conflict but lacked substance.

[Deccan Herald](#)

GS1 GS2 GS4 Women's safety is a national security issue

Crimes against women are treated as isolated incidents rather than a national security crisis requiring multi-agency high alerts. While Delhi smoothly hosted major international events like the Brics summit and SEMICON India 2026 with heavy VIP security, multiple rapes made headlines. Police cited lack of proper lighting for not patrolling the 142-acre Astha Kunj Park, an excuse unacceptable if given by border soldiers or intelligence agencies.

[Hindustan Times](#)

GS2 Caught Zzz-ing with first-time voters

Recent delays in voter registration and stalled revision processes put the Election Commission under scrutiny regarding first-time voters. The Election Commission is currently attempting to address issues regarding electoral roll updates and voter registration. Recent delays have affected the inclusion of new voters, especially young individuals. The annual Summary Special Revision was stalled, leading to a disruption in the registration process. Officials are now directed to implement a special enrollment drive for first-time voters.

[Economic Times](#)

GS3 India's glass buildings are killing birds. We know how to stop them

Birds frequently crash into glass facades and windows because they cannot distinguish glass from free space, often worsened by tree reflections. While the United States records about one billion bird deaths annually from glass collisions, comprehensive national data is currently lacking in India. Researchers like Peeyush Sekhsariya and Ashwin Vishwanathan have identified 110 bird species killed by architecture across various Indian locations. A December 2025 study in the journal *Ornis Hungarica* documented bird collisions at two buildings within the Nilgiri Biosphere Reserve.

[ThePrint](#)

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

What is the Tamil Nadu government's one-gram gold ring scheme? Tamil Nadu Chief Minister S. Joseph Vijay will launch the one-gram gold ring scheme for newborns on September 28 in Madurai. The initiative is named 'Thaai Maaman Thanga Mothiram Thittam' or Maternal Uncle Gold Ring Scheme.

[The Hindu](#)

Should voting be a fundamental right? A recent rift inside the Election Commission surfaced as 97 eligible voters in Goa were blocked from electoral rolls by the centralised software ECINet. The right to vote in India is currently a statutory right under Section 62 of the Representation of the People Act, 1951, rather than a fundamental right.

[The Hindu](#)

What does the law say about CEC's removal? Opposition parties began collecting signatures for a fresh notice seeking the removal of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. The move follows reports that election commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi raised formal objections 14 times in 10 months over electoral roll revisions.

[The Hindu](#)

Explained: Opposition's Attack On Chief Election Commissioner Without Numbers Removing the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) involves a complex constitutional process similar to that of a Supreme Court judge. The ECI has faced criticism from the Opposition following a recent media report, prompting discussions on CEC removal. The core issue highlights a strategic political maneuver by the Opposition despite facing an insurmountable parliamentary numbers deficit.

[NDTV](#)

Is ECI Correct In Saying Supreme Court Upheld Its New Form 6 Declaration? The controversy arose from public statements and legal scrutiny surrounding the validity and judicial endorsement of the revised voter enrolment forms. This explainer examines the accuracy of the Election Commission of India's assertion that the Supreme Court upheld its newly introduced Form 6 voter registration declaration.

[LiveLaw](#)

What is Karnataka's objection to the ESA? The Karnataka Legislature passed a unanimous resolution on September 22 opposing the ESA draft notification. This explainer details Karnataka's opposition to the Centre's draft notification on declaring parts of the Western Ghats as an Ecologically Sensitive Area. Why has the State repeatedly rejected the ESA draft?

[The Hindu](#)

Election Commission's nine new decisions: What changes and what doesn't The Election Commission announced a set of nine new decisions regarding electoral procedures. The Election Commission has introduced nine new decisions aimed at reforming and streamlining electoral processes.

[Indian Express](#)

As Trump rejects Iran peace proposal, what does each side want? It is in the news due to recent diplomatic developments and statements regarding a peace proposal involving the United States and Iran. Donald Trump has reportedly rejected an Iranian peace proposal, raising questions about the objectives and demands of both nations.

[Indian Express](#)

Behind Maharashtra drought crisis, sharp regional variation in rainfall The persistent agrarian distress and water scarcity across vulnerable regions of Maharashtra brought the recurring drought crisis into focus. An analysis of the Maharashtra drought crisis reveals that sharp regional variations in rainfall distribution and deficient monsoon spells are triggering widespread agricultural distress in the state.

[Indian Express](#)

What is causing the flood-like situation in Uttar Pradesh? Fifty-six people were killed and 46 injured in rain and storm-related incidents across Uttar Pradesh during an intense three-day wet spell. The state recorded 45.1 mm of rainfall in the 24 hours ending Sunday, drastically higher than the normal 1.8 mm.

[msn.com](#)

This Week in Explainers: When Donald Trump wooed Xi Jinping It was featured in the weekly explainer roundup published by Firstpost. An explainer detailing the diplomatic engagements and interactions between Donald Trump and Chinese leader Xi Jinping.

[Firstpost](#)

Knowledge Nugget | Why deep-ocean exploration and polymetallic nodules matter It is in the news as a knowledge nugget for UPSC aspirants regarding deep-ocean exploration and critical minerals. This explainer details the significance of deep-ocean exploration and the role of polymetallic nodules in powering the green energy transition.

[Indian Express](#)

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- ASEAN Countries Show Growing Interest In BRICS Amid Push For Strategic Autonomy: Report (International Relations) [Ommcom News](#)
- Odds of rate hike at RBI's October MPC meet on the rise: Economists (Economy) [ianslive.in](#)
- UNGA 2026: India Defends Its Indus Waters Treaty Stand, Calls for UN Reform (International Relations) [The Quint](#)
- Will exercise right to defend against terrorism: India at UN (International Relations) [Economic Times](#)
- Bharat Maritime Insurance Pool (Economy) [PIB](#)
- Power from Waste (Governance & Policy) [PIB](#)
- Floods and landslides kill at least 56 people in India, 12 in Nepal (Disaster Management) [Al Jazeera](#)
- At UNGA, India terms targeting of seafarers amid ongoing Gulf conflict 'simply unacceptable' (International Relations) [Press Trust of India](#)
- India's tourism sector contributes 5.22% to GDP, supports 8.46 crore jobs: Govt (Economy) [BusinessLine](#)
- Parliamentary panel seeks explanation from MCA over non-implementation of reservation policy in ICAI (Polity & Constitution) [BusinessLine](#)
- ESA row heats up in Pathanamthitta as Keralam government's proposal offers partial relief (Environment & Ecology) [The Hindu](#)
- External Affairs Minister tells UN General Assembly that bids to claim immunity for terrorism will not stand (International Relations) [Civildaily](#)
- Supreme Court orders action against Mau SPs from 2023 over 'casual approach' in criminal case trial (Polity & Constitution) [Hindustan Times](#)
- China conducts naval, air exercise around disputed shoal in South China Sea (International Relations) [Economic Times](#)
- Nations should shape own AI ecosystems, says EAM Jaishankar at UNGA (Science & Technology) [business-standard.com](#)
- Nanomedicine to Drive the Next Generation of Precision Medicine and Personalised Healthcare: Dr. Jitendra Singh (Science & Technology) [PIB](#)
- Afghanistan says 28 fighters killed after crossing from Pakistan (International Relations) [The Hindu](#)
- Private sector capex projected to rise to Rs. 3.2 trn in FY27: RBI bulletin (Economy) [Business Standard](#)
- GST Council likely to give green signal for freight movement by metro trains (Economy) [BusinessLine](#)
- Supreme Court Upholds Union of India's Appeal in Pension Clubbing Case Under Central Administrative Tribunal (Salaries, Allowances and Conditions of Service) Rules, 1985. Rule 8 of CAT Rules Held Exhaustive and Bars Combining State Judicial Service (Polity & Constitution) [Lawtext](#)

- ‘Durable peace requires 2-state solution’: India at UN on Israel-Palestine (International Relations) [Hindustan Times](#)
- Piyush Goyal may hold bilateral meeting with USTR Jamieson Greer this week (International Relations) [Business Standard](#)
- PM Narendra Modi Mentions Gujarats Modhera Sun Temple In 138th Mann Ki Baat Programme; What Makes This UNESCO (History, Art & Culture) [Free Press Journal](#)
- What is analogue paneer? FSSAI ban proposal and health risks explained (Governance & Policy) [Deccan Herald](#)
- UAE-India-SL Trincomalee energy hub MoU discussed (International Relations) [Island.lk](#)
- Supreme Court to examine plea challenging new UPI merchant charges (Economy) [Telangana Today](#)
- BRICS-ASEAN Closeness Boosts India's Strategic Advantage (International Relations) [India Narrative](#)
- NEET paper leak impact: CISF to guard NTA premises; stricter monitoring for 'confidential' areas (Governance & Policy) [The Hindu](#)
- COP31 hosts Australia and Türkiye face the fossil-fuel question (Environment & Ecology) [The Hindu](#)
- Govt reduces Basic Customs Duty on crude edible oils amid rising global prices (Economy) [All India Radio \(NewsOnAir\)](#)
- Discuss in the light of the Sone River pact how political forums like Zonal Councils can resolve interstate water disputes more effectively than Article 262 tribunals. (Polity & Constitution) [GKToday](#)
- India calls for fair pathogen access and benefit sharing under WHO pandemic agreement (International Relations) [Deccan Herald](#)
- Shaping India's Semiconductor Ecosystem... (Science & Technology) [Drishti IAS](#)
- BRICS and India's Strategic Opportunity... (International Relations) [Drishti IAS](#)
- Brics summit's untold story: India's Plan B for a fractured world (International Relations) [Firstpost](#)
- The Election Commission Dissent Is Our King Lear Moment (Polity & Constitution) [The Leaflet](#)
- India's Jaishankar meets Lavrov at UNGA, discusses Ukraine, Middle East (International Relations) [NewsBytes](#)
- Jaishankar Puts Two-State Solution Alongside India's Global South Pitch At UNGA (International Relations) [TheWire.in](#)
- COP31 in Antalya: From Climate Commitments to Implementation (Environment & Ecology) [Indian PSU](#)
- High-Altitude Warfare at Yudh Abhyas 2026: Indian and US Troops Train with Sako Rifles and 3D-Printed Drones (Defence) [Defence.in](#)
- President Murmu holds talks with Romanian counterpart, pitches India-EU FTA to boost trade and jobs (International Relations) [DD News](#)
- India's Sanitation Mission Must Move Beyond Toilets (Governance & Policy) [The Policy Edge](#)
- New pork import rules face a WTO compliance test (Economy) [Policy Circle](#)
- What Does The BRICS Opposition Mean For Other Regional Blocs In The Era Of CBAM? (Economy) [Eurasia Review](#)
- Jaishankar meets Canadian, Mexican, Venezuelan counterparts at UNGA (International Relations) [Business Standard](#)
- Beyond BRICS: India, between the horns (International Relations) [Newsyay](#)
- Beyond Trade And Geopolitics, India Pushes Cultural Ties Across BRICS (International Relations) [businessworld.in](#)
- Discovery of 3 Sistan sand boas in Rajasthan marks species' first official record in India (Environment & Ecology) [Hindustan Times](#)
- The Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Development (Amendment) Bill, 2026 (Economy) [PIB](#)
- Powering India's Solar Future (Infrastructure & Energy) [Drishti IAS](#)
- Centre directs captive coal plants to run at full capacity from October 1 (Infrastructure & Energy) [Civildaily](#)
- Supreme Court Dismisses Appellant in Land Acquisition Act Matter, Upholding Reduced Compensation for Poultry Business Loss. Section 23(1) Clauses Fourthly and Fifthly Do Not Extend to Loss of Profits Until Resettlement or Disadvantages of a Far-Off Inse (Polity & Constitution) [Lawtext](#)
- Critically discuss how the shifts in United States' security guarantees in West Asia are driving regional powers to forge independent trilateral defense alliances. Explain why. (International Relations) [GKToday](#)

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 11 must-know, 27 Prelims facts, 53 in the news, 15 editorials, 12 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — International Relations (9), Polity & Constitution (6), Economy (4), Infrastructure & Energy (4), Social Justice & Welfare (3), Agriculture & Allied (3), Defence (3), Governance & Policy (2), Environment & Ecology (2), Health (1), Internal Security (1). **Nothing today in** — Education, Science & Technology, Disaster Management, History, Art & Culture, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): 3 · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: 4 · Political change in the neighbourhood: 1 · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: nothing today · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: nothing today

Full text — 39 of 65 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — The Hindu 10, ddnews.gov.in 5, Economic Times 5, PIB 4, ThePrint 4, Indian Express 4, Hindustan Times 3, Deccan Herald 3, BusinessLine 2, msn.com 2, newindianexpress.com 2, Lawtext 1, theprint.in 1, indiatoday.in 1

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